

A personal check-in

Recognising Burnout, Spiritual Dryness, and Emotional Overload

Mark every line that describes you in the past month. Keep this page private. This is a private reflection, not a scored test or diagnosis. You may recognise signs from more than one description.

When to ask for more help. If low mood, emptiness or loss of interest has been present most days for two weeks or more, or is affecting your work, sleep, eating or relationships, please speak with a doctor or a qualified mental-health professional. If you have thoughts of not wanting to be alive, tell a trusted person and contact a qualified mental-health professional or crisis service promptly. **If you believe you may act on those thoughts, have formed a plan, or cannot keep yourself safe, do not continue the retreat alone: contact emergency services or a crisis line where you are now, and ask a trusted person to stay with you.**

Burnout

- ☐ Dreading things you used to find meaningful, including ministry or service
- ☐ Feeling that you have nothing left to give, even to people you love
- ☐ Increasing cynicism or numbness towards the people you serve
- ☐ Resentment that surfaces as irritability, sarcasm or withdrawal
- ☐ Finding it increasingly difficult to concentrate, complete responsibilities, or believe that your work makes a difference
- ☐ Needing more effort to accomplish tasks that once felt manageable
- ☐ Going through the motions of prayer and church without any sense of connection
- ☐ Physical changes such as persistent headaches, disrupted sleep, low energy, digestive problems or frequent illness (these should not automatically be put down to burnout; new, severe or persistent symptoms deserve a doctor's attention)
- ☐ A quiet fantasy of simply walking away from everything

Spiritual dryness

- ☐ Prayer that feels one-directional or mechanical
- ☐ Reading Scripture without feeling engaged, nourished or personally responsive
- ☐ Feeling nothing in worship, and then feeling guilty about feeling nothing
- ☐ Wondering whether earlier experiences of God were real
- ☐ Avoiding prayer because it has become disappointing
- ☐ A vague sense of distance that you cannot trace to any specific cause

Emotional overload

- ☐ Crying, or being close to it, without an obvious trigger
- ☐ Reacting to small problems as if they were large ones
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating, making decisions or remembering things
- ☐ A sense of being emotionally flat, as though nothing reaches you
- ☐ Avoiding people or conversations because you cannot manage one more thing
- ☐ Losses or hurts from months or years ago that still feel raw when touched

Then answer four questions

1. Looking at the signs you marked, which experiences seem most relevant to you right now? You may recognise more than one.

2. How long has this been going on? Weeks, months or longer? When did you first notice?

3. Is there a specific event you can connect it to (a loss, a move, a conflict, a change of role), or did it build gradually with no obvious cause?

4. Did the note "When to ask for more help" describe you? If so, what support do you need today? Write the name of the person, doctor, counsellor, crisis service or emergency service you will contact.

Keep your answers. Session 1 of the retreat will ask you to bring them.